LOCAL NEWS.

THEMENDOUS CONFLAGRATION.

A WHOLE BLOCK DESTROYED.

One of the Finest Fires ever known in Hamilton.

At about half-past one on Sunday morning, one of the worst fires that has ever occurred in Hamilton broke out in the rear of No. 7 York street, near Bay street, behind Corby's Hotel, and in a few minutes the whole of the Fire Brigade and an immense concourse of citizens were quietly on the spot. It appears that the fire broke out in the cabinet shop on York street, between Bay and Caroline streets, occupied by Mr. Thomas Freestone-room, and owned by Mr. Burns. The building was a large one, and was filled to a full height with valuable stock of furniture, manufactured, and, notwithstanding the assertions of the firemen, were quickly communicated to the surrounding buildings. Added to this, the fact of the hose not being to be stretched up with end and stone, evidently a malicious act, and as a very inadequate force of water was able to be thrown on the fire, the flames had a fair chance to do their work. The fire department, however, were on the spot in long distance time, and we have heard of some being fired to be distant as the Hamilton and Lake Erie Railway track. James street was full of clothes, and it is a wonder that none of the buildings were not set on fire,—when we have the roof of the St. Nicholas Hotel full of sparks. The heat was very great, and the expensive account of one building that we have saved Copps' Foundry and other adjacent buildings. The fancy goods of the exhibit store of Hewitt's planing factory and set on fire the large pile of lumber surrounded the building. This was prompt communication to the roof and burnt quickly. The crowd was now immense, and was increasing every minute, and extended for a considerable way. Just about this time a shout was raised and the huge head on the top of Hewitt's factory fell down with a crash, evidently it struck against the wires and a long spun them for a moment of the people, this enabling the crowd underneath to get out of the way of the falling mass, and no one was hurt. Most of the damage done is to the bottom flat were got out, but the upper stories were destroyed, and the loss is estimated is heavy. The next building, occupied by Copp Bros., and occupied by Messrs. Dunn & Hill as a furniture manufactory, which was also completely destroyed. Beside this was an old brick building, owned by Copp Bros., the front part of which was used as a paint shop and the bulk rented by Mr. Davis as a dwelling house. This was also destroyed, and the fire then crept up to the next building, owned by Mr. Pedersen as a saw-filing and repairing shop. There was no occupant to make an insurance building, but Mr. Fairbanks is fully covered, he had a policy for $1,000 and the estimate of his loss $500. Further to the east was Dr. Agricola's Manufactory. The portion of Copp Bros., a frame building used as a paint shop, and a large quantity of stuff, and a wing used was a brick building used as a store-house for patterns, which was full, and east of this was a brick and enamelling department, with about 4,000 moulds building. This was also nearly saved, with an insurance of $3,000 on the buildings. The patterns, however, were not insured. The large buildings and was rooms of Copp Bros. were also saved, but were very much damaged, having the roof and sides on fire and several times. Mr. Neath is insured for $1,200 which will cover his loss, as the company we do not know as yet. The boiler in Harrell Hill's factory was insured for $1,000 by Messrs. Difford, of London, who had the policy on the property. The loss is estimated at $1,000. Fortunately there were very few spectators with a Scotch Enlightened Fire Brigade, and at the same time assisted in sprinkling the assembled multitude. The whole loss may be estimated at about $20,000.

NEARLY A FATAL ACCIDENT.

The Wall of a Building Tumbles Down.

As the workmen who are employed on a third flat of the building on the corner of James and York street were engaged on Saturday afternoon hoisting up a wheel-barrow full of bricks to the second flat, the wall of the building on the south side of the building, which was not connected with the remainder, was suddenly tumbled against the building on the south side. Several men were engaged in the work of demolishing the western gable, but had not many hours before the fall. Mr. Lansing was engaged in the work and the occurrence narrated above took place. Mr. Lansing was on the second flat of the building and was near the building on the south side. He was in the act of throwing a brick to the workmen on the third flat, when he heard a crash, and looking around he saw the wall of the building on the south side tumbling down. He made a rush for the door, and succeeded in escaping with his life. The wall fell with a crash, and the bricks flew in every direction, some of them narrowly missing the heads of the workmen on the third flat. The wall was about two feet in thickness, and was about 30 feet in height. The loss sustained by the fall of the wall will be considerable, as the portion which fell contained a large number of bricks, which will be entirely destroyed. The building is owned by Mr. Lansing, and is occupied by Messrs. Dunn & Hill as a furniture manufactory, and by Mr. Davis as a dwelling house. The building was erected about 30 years ago, and is a very old building. The portion which fell was not connected with the remainder of the building, and was not supported by it. Mr. Thomas Freestone, who occupies the building on the corner of James and York streets, had had many narrow escapes from the falling of the portions which fell, but this was the narrowest escape of all. Mr. Freestone's loss